



Marketing Makeover Plan for Ponce City Market

Prepared for: Jamestown L.P.

Prepared by: SONAA Consulting Group (Group 3)

Aragstan Ainashe

Sira Camara

Olivia Phillips

Allen Robison

Nathan Shin

Executive Summary

This document serves as a comprehensive marketing makeover plan for Ponce City Market, developed by SONAA Consulting Group to evaluate the property's current marketing strategy and recommend opportunities for growth. This analysis identified opportunities to increase repeat visits, strengthen customer loyalty, and improve brand awareness. Based on these findings, the strategic recommendations developed address these challenges through targeted marketing initiatives. Together, these recommendations aim to enhance the customer experience and support Ponce City Market's long-term success.

Opening Video: [SONAA PCM INTRO](#)

1. SWOT Analysis & Business Challenges

SWOT Analysis

Strengths

- Automated event alerts via messaging
- Fun, eventful activities — pop-up markets, rooftop, food hall
- Trendy urban identity with strong local brand
- Direct BeltLine access
- Rich architectural history

Weaknesses

- Low customer lifetime value — visitors don't return
- Weak event marketing — low awareness of programming
- Limited digital presence — mostly Instagram only
- No incentive to return — "no reason to come back"
- Perceived as expensive — rooftop, parking, dining
- Parking problems — confusing, costly, heavy fines
- Overcrowded weekends, dead on weekdays

Opportunities

- Ponce Passport — property-wide loyalty program
- Expanded traditional marketing across Metro Atlanta
- Improved parking & arrival experience
- Wi-Fi upgrade — attract students & remote workers
- Wayfinding improvements — help visitors discover more

Threats

- The Battery Atlanta
- Atlantic Station
- Major Atlanta tourist attractions
- Krog Street Market — up 28% in foot traffic since 2018

Our Main Goal

Improve PCM's marketing without changing what makes it great. Growth through enhancement, not change.

Business Challenges (from SWOT)

- **Challenge 1 — Low Customer Lifetime Value & Repeat Visits**
 - *Weaknesses: no return incentive, expensive, over-monetized*
 - *Opportunity: loyalty program, better parking, wayfinding, Wi-Fi*
- **Challenge 2 — Advertising**
 - *Weaknesses: limited reach, digital-only marketing*
 - *Opportunity: expand traditional media, position PCM as Atlanta landmark*

4 P's — Most Impacted

- **Price** — *loyalty incentives & parking rewards lower perceived cost*
- **Promotion** — *expand traditional media across Metro Atlanta*
- **Product** — *Ponce Passport & Wi-Fi upgrade add new visitor value*
- **Place** — *wayfinding & MARTA partnerships improve arrival experience*

Textbook Citations

For Threats / Competitive Environment: Essentials of Marketing, Ch. 3, p. 68 — Sustainable Competitive Advantage. PCM's historic building, BeltLine access, and community identity are advantages competitors like The Battery and Krog Street cannot replicate.

For Narrowing Down Business Challenges: Essentials of Marketing, Ch. 3, p. 87 — Screening Criteria. Guided our process of identifying which weaknesses to prioritize and which opportunities to act on.

2. Marketing Ideas → Challenges and Recommendations

Challenge 1: Low Customer Lifetime Value & Repeat Visits

- **1A — No loyalty program** — no property-wide rewards encouraging return visits
- **1B — Limited reasons to return** — PCM seen as one-time destination
- **1C — Low perceived value** — cost of parking, dining & rooftop feels unjustified

Challenge 2: Advertising

- **2A — Limited digital reach** — over-reliant on Instagram alone
- **2B — Low tourist awareness** — not promoted as must-visit Atlanta destination
- **2C — Weak traditional advertising** — untapped billboards, MARTA, radio, print

Recommendations — Tactics, Cost, Timing, Outcomes

Recommendation	Tactic	Est. Cost	Timing	Expected Outcome
Ponce Passport (Loyalty Program)	Printed passport booklet stamped at checkout. Rewards: free rooftop, parking tokens, member merch, exclusive events. Passport members get premium Wi-Fi; non-members get basic access.	\$20,000 (production, stamps) \$15,000 (Wi-Fi infrastructure) Total: \$35,000	Q1: Design & print Q2-Q3: Launch & scale	20% more repeat visits. Wi-Fi brings in weekday regulars. <u>Addresses Challenge 1.</u>
Friendly Arrival Experience	Parking hosts on-site to assist guests. Clear payment instructions posted. Discount tokens for \$25+ purchases. 3D floor maps & QR navigation at BeltLine entrances and elevators.	\$10,000 (hosts, signs, tokens) \$12,000 (maps & signs) Total: \$22,000	Q1: Staff training & Navigator install	Better parking reputation. Encourage visitor spending <u>Addresses Challenge 1.</u>
Traditional Media Marketing	Focus on promoting upcoming events, and cementing PCM as Atlanta's cultural identity (Brand Awareness) Billboards: I-85, Downtown, Suburban MARTA: Wrapped buses, posters at stations, directions from station Local Radio&Print: Atlanta Magazine, radio stations	\$35,000 billboards \$25,000 MARTA \$10,000 print \$15,000 radio \$15,000 production Total: \$100,000	Q1: Plan & book ad space Q2-Q4: Live campaign	Wide Metro Atlanta exposure. PCM is positioned as a must-visit landmark. Reaches tourists & commuters. <u>Addresses Challenge 2.</u>

Textbook Citations

Challenge 1 — Low Customer Lifetime Value: Essentials of Marketing, Ch. 2, p. 45 — Customer Lifetime Value. Loyal customers continue buying from brands that satisfy them, increasing long-term profitability. PCM's low CLV signals visitors aren't satisfied enough to return — the Ponce Passport directly targets this by building repeat visit habits.

For The 4 P's / Recommendations: Essentials of Marketing, Ch. 2, p. 38 — The Four Ps Marketing Mix. All four Ps must work together to deliver customer value to the target market. Our recommendations address all four — Passport (Product), MARTA & wayfinding (Place), billboards (Promotion), and bundle offers & parking tokens (Price).

For Customer Retention vs. Acquisition: Essentials of Marketing, Ch. 2, p. 48 — Customer Equity. It costs less to retain a customer than acquire a new one. This insight drives our entire strategy — the Ponce Passport, Wi-Fi, and arrival experience all prioritize retaining existing visitors over chasing new ones.

3. Target Audience

Primary:

Socially-Active Urbanists

Atlanta-based young professionals and creatives aging from 18 to 39, earning between \$45,000 and \$85,000 annually. They live or work within 5 miles of Ponce City Market, and have likely visited PCM before but do not think of it as a regular weekly destination.

Why our recommendation works:

The Ponce Passport rewards frequent visitors by creating meaningful incentives for customers who already have access to PCM, deepening their connection to the market and increasing how often they return.

The Friendly Parking Experience removes the single most cited barrier to repeat visits — transforming what is currently a source of frustration into a seamless, welcoming entry point.

Traditional Media Marketing expands PCM's reach across Metro Atlanta through billboards, MARTA transit placements, radio, and print — meeting commuters, tourists, and locals wherever they already are, and cementing PCM's identity as an essential piece of Atlanta's cultural landscape.

Secondary:

Tourists & Visitors with Disposable Income

Out-of-town visitors to Atlanta, ages 25–55, traveling for leisure or business with household incomes above \$75,000. They are actively seeking authentic, locally-rooted Atlanta experiences beyond standard tourist attractions.

Why our recommendation works:

Traditional Media Marketing intercepts this audience at every entry point into the city — MARTA placements capture visitors arriving from Hartsfield-Jackson Airport, I-85 billboards reach those driving in, and Atlanta Magazine reaches travel planners before they even land — positioning PCM as Atlanta's must-visit cultural destination.

Textbook Citations

For Defining Target Audiences: Essentials of Marketing, Ch. 4, p. 100 — *Market Segmentation. Our two segments are homogeneous, substantial, and operationally reachable with different marketing mixes.*

For Why Locals Return: Essentials of Marketing, Ch. 5, p. 131 — *PSSPS Hierarchy of Needs (Social Needs). The Ponce Passport targets belonging and affiliation — making PCM feel like a community, not a one-time stop.*

For Positioning PCM as Local vs. Tourist Destination: Essentials of Marketing, Ch. 4, p. 118 — *Differentiation and Positioning. Our plan repositions PCM from a one-time tourist stop to Atlanta's neighborhood destination, addressing the perception gap driving low return rates.*

4. Traditional Marketing & Promotion

Traditional Strategy

To align with PCM's goal of remaining a technology-free space, this strategy prioritizes and expands upon traditional media promotion methods.

PCM's marketing is rooted in placemaking and experiential marketing, heavily relying on physical, in-person experiences and heritage branding rather than standard digital ads. We're not trying to replace PCM's traditional marketing strategy, we want to evolve it.

- **Community Events Sponsorship** — BeltLine events, neighborhood festivals, local arts programming
- **Local Billboards** — I-85, Downtown Atlanta, and suburban corridors
- **MARTA Advertising** — Wrapped buses, station posters, directions from Five Points and Midtown stations
- **Atlanta Magazine** — Print placements reaching upscale local readers and travel-planning visitors

Social Media

- **Radio Advertising** — Local stations popular with our 22–38 primary audience, promoting upcoming events
- **External Creator Partnership** — Partnering with local creators to share their experiences. Spreading awareness on events, brand image, and boosting community. Featuring them inside of traditional media.

Textbook Citations (Essentials of Marketing)

Traditional Marketing: Essentials of Marketing, Ch. 13, p. 397 — Promotion Blends Blended and Integrated. No single promotion method fits all situations — effective plans combine multiple channels. Our mix of traditional media like billboards, MARTA, and radio applies this directly.

For PCM's Current Marketing Stage: Essentials of Marketing, Ch. 13, p. 403 — Promotion Blends Vary over the Product Life Cycle (Market Maturity Stage). In maturity, mass selling and sales promotion dominate. PCM is a mature brand — our plan shifts focus from awareness to selective demand, giving locals a reason to choose PCM over competitors repeatedly.

5. Product, Price, Promotion, and Place Recommendation

Place

- Better MARTA partnerships
- Wayfinding improvements from the BeltLine.
- Better guides and directory

Addresses Challenge 2 — increases tourist awareness & accessibility

Product

- Better Wi-Fi
- "Ponce Passport" loyalty program: A physical booklet that rewards repeat visits. Customers collect ink stamps at registers across retail, dining, and entertainment venues to redeem for free rooftop access, parking discount tokens, exclusive merchandise, or member-only event invitations.

Addresses Challenge 1 — directly increases dwell time and return likelihood

Price

- Free or discounted parking after spending a certain amount.
- Resident-exclusive weekday promotions.
- Bundle offers (e.g., dinner + rooftop admission).
- Seasonal loyalty rewards.
- Birthday perks for loyalty members.

Addresses Challenge 1 — bundle offers and tokens lower perceived cost, making the experience feel worth returning to

Promotion

- Community events sponsorship
- Local billboards
- Marta advertising
- Atlanta Magazine
- Radio Sponsorship

Addresses Challenge 2 — expands awareness beyond existing audience through both traditional and digital channels

Textbook Citations

For Ponce Passport (Product): Essentials of Marketing, Ch. 8, p. 223 — What Is a Product? A product is the need-satisfying offering of a firm — including services, experiences, and benefits, not just physical goods. The Ponce Passport is a product-level addition that enhances the overall PCM experience and gives customers a new reason to return.

For Wayfinding & MARTA (Place): Essentials of Marketing, Ch. 10, p. 289 — Place Decisions Are Guided by Ideal Place Objectives. Goods and services must be available in the right quantities and locations when customers want them. PCM's wayfinding improvements and MARTA partnerships directly address accessibility and navigation gaps.

For Keeping Small Local Retailers: Essentials of Marketing, Ch. 12, p. 365 — Why Retailers Evolve and Change. Successful retailers continuously adapt their mix to meet changing customer needs. PCM should evolve its marketing support for local retailers rather than replacing them — preserving the authentic identity that differentiates it from competitors.

For Loyalty Program / Pricing Strategy: Essentials of Marketing, Ch. 12, p. 367 — Technology & Loyalty Cards. Retailers use loyalty programs to collect customer data and deliver personalized experiences. The Ponce Passport applies this same principle — rewarding repeat visits and building long-term customer relationships.

6. Marketing Budget Recommendation

Activity	Est. Cost	% of Budget
Billboards	\$35,000	22%
MARTA	\$25,000	16%
Radio	\$15,000	10%
Atlanta Magazine	\$10,000	6%
Ponce Passport + Member Wi-Fi	\$35,000	22%
Friendly Arrival Experience	\$22,000	14%
Production & Design (all materials)	\$15,000	10%
TOTAL	\$157,000	100%

Budget Reasoning

- **Billboards (22%)** — Highest reach, captures commuters and tourists entering the city daily
- **MARTA (16%)** — Intercepts tourists from Hartsfield-Jackson before they choose a destination
- **Radio (10%)** — Consistent weekly exposure to local commuters at low production cost
- **Atlanta Magazine (6%)** — Targets upscale local readers and travel planners aligned with our audience
- **Ponce Passport + Wi-Fi (22%)** — Production, custom stamps, and incentive fulfillment for loyalty program launch, Wifi infrastructure
- **Friendly Arrival Experience (14%)** — Host training, updated signage, discount tokens, 3D floor maps
- **Production & Design (10%)** — Design costs covering all print, billboard, MARTA, and passport materials

7. Implementation Roadmap (Quarterly)

Month	Goal	Activity
Q1 Awareness & Planning	Build foundation before launch	Book billboard, MARTA, radio & magazine ad space. Begin Passport design & print. Install parking hosts & wayfinding signage. Influencers Ambassadors. Begin Wi-Fi upgrades.
Q2 Improve Experience	Get visitors to stay longer & return	Launch Ponce Passport. Go live with all traditional media. Roll out weekday rooftop discounts. Complete Wi-Fi upgrade. Install all floor maps & QR points. Launch bundle offers.
Q3 Build Loyalty	Drive repeat visits & satisfaction	Scale best Q2 events. Promote summer bundles. Activate birthday perks for members. Collect feedback on parking, Wi-Fi & value. Adjust promotions based on data.
Q4 Evaluate & Expand	Measure results & plan ahead	Promote holiday events & seasonal programming. Measure: Passport membership, CLV, event attendance, parking satisfaction, weekday foot traffic. Use data to plan next year's strategy.

8. Reflection

Biggest disagreement & resolution

- Disagreement: Narrowing down on which elements to focus on for the target market, biggest challenges, and recommendations.

Resolution: Making the problems simpler and broader, rather than overly detailed. Referring to the interview conducted with the Jamestown Senior Creative Manager to figure out their current strategy.

Hardest recommendation for the owner to implement

- Keeping their traditional values and brand image while improving their strategies

How AI helped or hindered your process

- Narrowing down important problems with web-researched facts, recommending ideas based on web research. Double-checking information and documents.

Appendix

- Textbook citations (Cited Across Document)
- Primary data collected by SONAA
 - Interview: Tourist Family, Discussing Map Layouts and Directory Confusion
[Tourist Interview](#)
 - Interview: Jamee Stradley, Senior Creative Manager at Jamestown
 - [Interview with Jamee Stradley, Jamestown](#)
- Secondary Data
 - [Ponce Google Reviews](#)
 - [Ponce History](#)
 - [Ponce City Market Events](#)